Mock Trial: Long-Term Team Project

State of Georgia v. Logan Haynes

Legal Environment of Business — Unit 2: The Court System & Dispute Resolution

Project Objective

Working in an assigned courtroom role — attorney, witness, judge, or courtroom staff — you will research, prepare for, and perform a full criminal mock trial based on a realistic case file, then reflect in writing on how the experience illustrates real criminal law concepts. This project is your simulation of the criminal court process required by the Georgia Legal Environment of Business standards, and it reinforces core legal concepts from Unit 1.

Minimum time commitment: 10 hours of project work, tracked across the full timeline below — including preparation, the two trial sessions, rehearsal, and reflection.

Georgia Standards Addressed

Primary standards (directly assessed through this project):

Standard	Description
BMA-LEB-3	Explain and illustrate through simulation the process by which a legal dispute is resolved for a business and personal issue.
BMA-LEB-3.1	Compare and contrast the federal and state court systems' functions and purpose and the impact on a business.
BMA-LEB-3.2	Distinguish between criminal and civil law.
BMA-LEB-3.6	Reconstruct the process of a criminal prosecution from arrest through sentencing from two different viewpoints — the person accused of the crime and the business owner.
BMA-LEB-3.7	Interpret an example legal dispute and analyze the impact on a business.
BMA-LEB-3.8	Relate a case study of legal dispute to criminal or civil law, federal or state court system, and litigation, arbitration, mediation, and conciliation.

Supporting standards (reinforced throughout the project):

Standard	Description
BMA-LEB-1	Employability skills: communication, creativity, critical thinking, work readiness, teamwork, and professional image — practiced in every team role.
BMA-LEB-2.2	Major sources of law (constitutional, statutory, common, regulatory) — referenced in the reflection essay.
BMA-LEB-2.3	Differentiating among crimes, torts, and contracts — relevant to understanding the charges in this case.

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Full Project Timeline

Every session below counts toward your 10-hour minimum. Sessions marked TRIAL DAY are shaded.

Date	Length	What Happens	Standards Addressed	Running Total
Fri, Aug 21	45 min	Case read-through & overview	BMA-LEB-3.6, 3.7, 3.2	**0h 45m**
Mon, Aug 24	45 min	Roles assigned	BMA-LEB-1.5	**1h 30m**
Tue, Aug 25	25 min	Initial work time	BMA-LEB-1.1, 3.7	**1h 55m**
Fri, Aug 28	47 min	Team work day — drafting begins	BMA-LEB-1.1, 1.2, 3.6, 3.7	**2h 42m**
Mon, Aug 31	47 min	Short check-in — teams keep drafting	BMA-LEB-1.1, 1.4	**3h 29m**
Tue, Sep 1	47 min	Final check-in — everything should be ready to run	BMA-LEB-1.1, 1.4	**4h 16m**
Wed, Sep 2	95 min	**TRIAL DAY 1 — openings + Prosecution's full case**	BMA-LEB-3.1, 3.2, 3.6, 3.7, 3.8	**5h 51m**
Tue, Sep 8	20 of 47 min	Final-touches rehearsal only — no full run-through	BMA-LEB-1.4, 1.5	**6h 11m**
Wed, Sep 9	95 min	**TRIAL DAY 2 — remaining Defense case, closings, verdict**	BMA-LEB-3.1, 3.2, 3.6, 3.7, 3.8	**7h 46m**
Fri, Sep 11	47 min	Reflection essay written; Prosecution & Defense present	BMA-LEB-2.2, 2.3, 3.2	**8h 33m**
Mon, Sep 14	47 min	Court Staff & Jury present; wrap-up discussion	BMA-LEB-2.2, 3.7, 3.8	**9h 20m**
Tue, Sep 15	40 of 47 min	Cross-class debrief & standards tie-in	BMA-LEB-3.7, 3.8, 1.1	**10h 00m**

Note: this class does not meet on Thursdays; the timeline above uses only Mon/Tue/Wed/Fri class periods. Days not listed are regular Unit 2 instruction, not project time.

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Grading Sheet (100 points total)

Fill in a score of 1 (Below) to 4 (Exceeds) for each criterion. See the full Grading Rubric document for detailed level descriptions for your specific role.

TIER 1 — All Attorneys & Witnesses (Performance 70% / Reflection 30%)

Performance criteria vary by Attorney vs. Witness role — use the matching set from the full rubric.

Trial Performance

Case knowledge — Score (1-4): _____
Direct examination — Score (1-4): _____
Cross examination — Score (1-4): _____
Courtroom presence — Score (1-4): _____

Reflection Essay

Depth of reflection — Score (1-4): _____
Use of evidence — Score (1-4): _____
Argument/thesis quality — Score (1-4): _____
Use of Unit 1 concepts — Score (1-4): _____

Performance total (÷16 × weight): _____ Reflection total (÷16 × weight): _____ FINAL GRADE (/100): _____

TIER 2 — Judge, Bailiff, Court Clerk, Court Reporter (Performance 50% / Reflection 50%)

Performance criteria are role-specific — use the matching set from the full rubric.

Trial Performance

Criterion 1 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Criterion 2 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Criterion 3 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Professionalism — Score (1-4): _____

Reflection Essay

Depth of reflection — Score (1-4): _____
Use of evidence — Score (1-4): _____
Argument/thesis quality — Score (1-4): _____
Use of Unit 1 concepts — Score (1-4): _____

Performance total (÷16 × weight): _____ Reflection total (÷16 × weight): _____ FINAL GRADE (/100): _____

TIER 3 — Timekeeper(s), Jury Foreperson, Jurors (Performance 30% / Reflection 70%)

Performance criteria are role-specific — use the matching set from the full rubric.

Trial Performance

Criterion 1 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Criterion 2 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Criterion 3 (role-specific) — Score (1-4): _____
Professionalism — Score (1-4): _____

Reflection Essay

Depth of reflection — Score (1-4): _____
Use of evidence — Score (1-4): _____
Argument/thesis quality — Score (1-4): _____
Use of Unit 1 concepts — Score (1-4): _____

Performance total (÷16 × weight): _____ Reflection total (÷16 × weight): _____ FINAL GRADE (/100): _____